

person enters the house or a room, a wearable device like Nymi could be used to immediately recognise and authenticate the user (using heartbeat patterns and other biometric modalities) to home automation systems, which can instantly revert to his or her preset preferences.

Lighting systems at home can also be made to reflect your mood. With modern light-emitting diode (LED) based lighting systems it is possible to make lights change their hue and brightness. Advanced lighting systems take into consideration aspects like position and movement of people, environmental conditions, activity being performed and time of the day to dynamically change the settings, while simpler ones let you program certain preset modes and choose one.

An Indian innovator, Rousing Designs, recently revealed EMO, a personalised lighting system that can be controlled through a mobile app to light up your space according to your mood. Read more about it in June issue, pages 38-40.

Your lights can even play music now. Sony recently launched an LED light bulb Bluetooth speaker that combines a 360-lumen bulb and a 2-watt, 40mm speaker that can be screwed into any standard light socket. The bulb can be controlled with a dedicated near-field communication (NFC) remote or a mobile app. To fill your home with music, you just need to fit some of these bulbs here and there.

Which OS does your TV run on

Think living room, and the television is the first thing that comes to mind. Indeed, television makers have been offering Internet connectivity for quite some time now, giving access to photos, videos and a lot of online content. However, the focus of connectivity is now shifting from simple streaming of online content to providing a personalised experience. Like in the case of mobile phones, buyers are now beginning to ask the question, "Which

operating system (OS)?" when they buy a television (TV).

Sony, Sharp and Philips are among those who have opted for Google's Android TV platform. Going for a common platform like this instead of a proprietary one ensures that your content and customisations stay with you even if you change your TV. Plus, if you use a TV with Android TV OS, you can



Belkin Motion image service
(Image courtesy: www.bjs.com)

Secure your home with

- Smartlocks like August, Goji and Haven
- Security cameras like Dropcam Pro, Nest Cam and Canary
- Motion sensors like Belkin Motion
- Complete solutions like Zicom's wireless home security system

also control it using your Android phone or tablet.

Panasonic uses Firefox OS, and it is evident that Firefox has built a TV-centric experience rather than simply extend its mobile OS for use on a bigger screen. Samsung uses Tizen OS, the company's new OS that is being rolled out on most of its devices, while LG sticks to its WebOS.

Taking on the giants is Roku TV, a new smart TV platform that is being used in several economical TV models from Hisense, Haier

and Sharp. With a robust search and other essential features, Roku seems to have got the basics right.

Tech to rest and dress well

When it is time to catch up on some sleep, there are products like ReST Bed that ensure even a short nap is a powerful recharge. ReST uses a special pressure-sensing fabric that monitors your pressure points and makes automatic real-time adjustments to ensure that your frame is properly supported. The dashboard provides sleep data, which helps judge your health condition and readiness for upcoming activities.

Cameras set up inside wardrobes can help you select clothes to wear on a particular day, having a quick glance at what is in the laundry and what is ready to wear. But, that is just too simple. How about a smart-wardrobe that can automatically steam-clean and dry your clothes, remove wrinkles and deodorise, too?

Well, that is just what LG unveiled last year. The company believes that LG Style can save a lot of time for busy people and can also be useful in office lockers and airport lounges.

Cooking and cleaning the smart way

Smart and connected refrigerators, coffee makers, slow cookers and dishwashers are old tales. From kitchen-tops to refrigerators, every part of your kitchen is getting connected and smart, with appliances and platforms from players like LG and Samsung.

You can view the contents of your fridge on your mobile phone and prepare your shopping list before leaving office. Your fridge door can show the use-by date of each item inside it. There are Wi-Fi-enabled egg holders that tell you how many eggs you have or by when these are to be used.

You can upload notes through a mobile app, to be displayed on the kitchen door for your kids or spouse